

Kamal Joshi

Senior Backend Engineer — CIAM & Identity Platform | OAuth 2.0 | OIDC | Okta | AWS | Distributed Systems | Security

Austin, TX | Open to remote-friendly and hybrid roles

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer with deep experience designing and operating identity, authorization, and API security platform services — including hands-on extension of Okta and Auth0 using custom hooks, policies, and Terraform providers. Built and owned an Authorization Service and Third-Party Integrations Service in production for a security platform serving enterprise customers, with a track record of end-to-end ownership through incidents, customer escalations, and multi-region rollouts. Strong security fundamentals applied through engineering: OAuth 2.0, OIDC, token lifecycle, access control models, and secure-by-design API patterns. Effective at directing AI tools (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Codex) across the full SDLC to move fast while owning the design and quality bar.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Identity & CIAM:** OAuth 2.0, OIDC, API key management, Okta (hooks, policies, Terraform provider), Auth0 (hooks, policies, Terraform provider), authorization services, token lifecycle, access control models, secure authentication flows
- **Backend engineering:** Go, Java, Spring Boot, Python (scripting/Lambda), REST, gRPC, JSON/HTTP APIs, microservices, event-driven systems, distributed systems
- **Cloud & infrastructure:** AWS Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, AWS Secrets Manager, Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD (Jenkins)
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Terraform modules, Terraform pipelines, multi-account infrastructure, Okta Terraform provider, Auth0 Terraform provider
- **Security fundamentals:** secure coding, OWASP remediation, rate-limit governance, OPA policy enforcement, threat analytics
- **Platform operations:** multi-region readiness, DLQ recovery, sovereign/GovCloud environments, observability, metrics instrumentation, deployment validation
- **AI-assisted SDLC:** daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Codex across implementation, IaC, testing, debugging, code review, and design exploration

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - Present | Austin, TX

- Owned backend/platform systems including **API Gateway**, **Authorization Service**, and **Third-Party Integrations Service** — spanning design, implementation, production support, and cross-team coordination on a security platform serving enterprise and government customers.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key authentication and APIGW rate-limit behavior, driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Prevented security-event message loss during a production incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and recovering within **5-10 minutes**.
- Drove integrations-svc production readiness across **sovereign and multi-region environments** by decomposing a high-risk Terraform rollout into staged changes across ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB streams, SNS, and service config — validating HA behavior across multiple regions.
- Mapped AuthSvc TLS secret synchronization and API key refresh behavior across Secrets Manager, Kubernetes, and Kong — reducing ambiguity for security-sensitive token lifecycle management.

- Led design and delivery of real-time security event push using the **CloudEvents** standard, delivering **alpha on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers.
- Drove cross-service design for **Splunk** and **CloudEvents** webhook delivery formats across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications services.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Built **auth-tools**, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services to simplify OAuth 2.0 / policy enforcement integration.
- Implemented metrics instrumentation for the Authorization Service and Integrations Service; owned production observability, alerting, and DLQ monitoring for identity-adjacent backend services.
- Led ISMAP security certification for the APIX platform, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements and meeting all deadlines.
- Integrated AI tooling (Claude Code, Copilot, Codex) into daily engineering workflow; pioneered team-wide GitHub Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco initiatives.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Extended **Okta** and **Auth0** with custom hooks and policies as part of the CX Cloud Identity platform; provisioned and managed both platforms using their **Terraform providers**.
- Built API-driven **OIDC and OAuth 2.0** authentication and authorization flows for cloud-native services.
- Designed and implemented Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs for a cloud-native data ingestion platform.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding practices, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, REST APIs, and integration features across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector domains.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, SQL, service integrations, and secure coding practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University